

Fulvia Oldrini

PH.D. CANDIDATE · ACCOUNTING

University of Zurich, Plattenstrasse 14, CH-8032 Zurich Switzerland

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Education

University of Zurich

PH.D. IN ACCOUNTING

Supervisor: Professor Hui Chen

Zurich, Switzerland

2020 - present

The Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania

VISITING PHD STUDENT

Host: Professor Luzi Hail

Main advisor: Professor Paul Fischer

Philadelphia, USA

2024 - 2025

University of Zurich

M.A. IN FINANCE

Honors cum laude

Zurich, Switzerland

2016 - 2019

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University

MASTER OF FINANCE

Exchange student

Hong Kong

2017

Università della Svizzera Italiana

B.SC. IN ECONOMICS

Honors magna cum laude

Lugano, Switzerland

2012 - 2015

Research Interest

Key words: Disclosure, real effects, external financing choices, institutional investors

My primary research interest is the role of information in financial markets, with a focus on strategic corporate disclosure and its real effects. In my projects, I study how disclosure shapes external financing choices, securities underpricing, institutional investors' interest, and project selection. I employ a diverse range of research methods, including analytical models, econometric analyses, and surveys.

Research

WORKING PAPERS

“Signaling with words or debt? The effect of voluntary disclosure on external public financing choices” (*Job market paper*)

Abstract: This paper examines how voluntary disclosure shapes capital structure choices between debt and equity in public markets under information asymmetry. I develop a model in which voluntary disclosure and debt issues are alternative signaling devices: disclosure complements equity and substitutes for debt. Good-type firms—those with higher future profitability—choose optimally between issuing debt or pairing disclosure with equity issues based on their relative costs, i.e., proprietary and bankruptcy costs. In a sample of U.S. public firms from 2003 to 2024, I find that, for good-type firms, disclosure is positively related to equity issues and negatively related to bond issues. Cross-sectional tests exploiting variation in proprietary disclosure costs and bankruptcy costs support the prediction that firms with higher disclosure costs are less likely to use the disclosure-equity bundle and issue debt instead, and that firms with higher bankruptcy costs are less likely to issue debt and use the disclosure-equity bundle instead. Two quasi-natural experiments—the 2005 Securities Offering Reform and the 2017 Tax Cuts and Jobs Act—support a causal interpretation of this substitution effect. This paper reconciles empirical inconsistencies in corporate finance theories by providing a mechanism that rationalizes equity issuance by many good-type firms.

Presented at: Wharton Accounting Workshop (2025), Philadelphia; Doctoral Seminar in Accounting Research, Zurich (2024).

“I need a network: determinants and real effects of bond roadshows” with Sike Chen and Mingxuan Ma

Abstract: We examine why firms hold roadshows when issuing bonds and their ex-post real effects on the cost of debt. We begin by conducting surveys with both bond issuers and underwriters, which reveal divergent priors regarding the reasons for bond roadshows. Underwriters claim that bond roadshows serve an informational role, while bond issuers claim that they serve a marketing role. We test these competing hypotheses in the German public corporate bond market (2014–2023). Consistent with the marketing view, we find that bond roadshows increase investor attention and primary market demand, and help issuers build networks of institutional investors. On the real effects of bond roadshows, we find that they are associated with a lower cost of debt and substitute for costly underpricing, since they compensate primary-market investors through early awareness provision. To our knowledge, this is the first study to jointly analyze the determinants and consequences of bond roadshows. We contribute to the literature by establishing that bond roadshows are structurally distinct from equity roadshows, which serve an informational role and are associated with underpricing.

Presented at: Hawaii Accounting Research Conference (HARC) 2026 (scheduled)*; Poster session of the Rising Scholar Conference in Finance, Zurich (2025); Doctoral Seminar in Accounting Research, Zurich (2025)*.

“Mandatory sustainability reporting and project selection” with Hui Chen

Abstract: We examine the implications of a regulatory shift in sustainability reporting from voluntary to mandated regime in a market with responsible investors. A myopic manager must choose between a brown project and a green project, both of which generate an uncertain financial return and an environmental externality. Since the information quality on externality is not perfect, the manager always under-invests in the green project in both reporting regimes, but more severely so in the voluntary regime due to the optional value voluntary disclosure provides in concealing bad information. Adopting mandatory disclosure thus improves firms’ sustainability performance and investor welfare. However, considering the costs associated with mandatory disclosure, it is more efficient only when the quality of a firm’s sustainability information is sufficiently high. To ensure an efficient shift to sustainability disclosure mandates, firms should first improve the quality of their sustainability information systems.

Presented at: Raising Scholars Conference on Sustainable Finance, Zurich (2024); 15th Workshop on Accounting and Economics WU, Vienna (2024); Doctoral Seminar in Analytical Accounting Research, Zurich (2023); 1st Interdisciplinary Workshop on Sustainability and ESG Dynamics LIUC Università Cattaneo, Milano (2023).

(*) stands for co-author presentation

WORK-IN-PROGRESS

“Environmental feedback effect” with Daniela Zipperer

“When horizons converge: investor selection, firm output and aggregate welfare” with Igli Bajo

Conferences and workshops

P for presenting author, D for discussant.

2025: 24th Conference of the German Economic Association of Business Administration 2025, WHU (D); Rising Scholar Conference in Finance 2025 poster session, Zurich (P); 14th Accounting Research Workshop, Zurich; Wharton Spring Accounting Conference, Philadelphia; NYU Four-School Accounting Research Conference, New York; Wharton Accounting Workshop, Philadelphia (P); FARS Midyear Meeting 2025, Atlanta

2024: Accounting and Economics Society (AES) Summer School at NYU, New York; Rising Scholars Conference on Sustainable Finance, Zurich (P); 15th Workshop on Accounting and Economics WU, Vienna (P); Doctoral Seminar in Accounting Research, Zurich (P)

2023: Doctoral Seminar in Analytical Accounting Research, Zurich (P); Economics of Sustainability Reporting CAR symposium, Graz; 1ST Interdisciplinary workshop on sustainability and ESG dynamics at LIUC Università Cattaneo, Milano (P); 13th Accounting Research Workshop in Zurich; Wharton Spring Accounting Conference, Philadelphia

2022: Doctoral Seminar in Accounting Research, Zurich (P)

2021: Doctoral Seminar in Analytical Accounting Research, Zurich (P); 12th Accounting Research Workshop, Online

Teaching Experience

TEACHING ASSISTANT

2021 - 2024	Financial Reporting, Prof. Hui Chen , Undergraduate (500 students). Responsible for in-class exercise sessions and office hours. Students evaluation: 5.1/6 (2023) and 5.2/6 (2024)	University of Zurich
2021 - 2022	Accounting Bootcamp, Prof. Hui Chen , Graduate (150 students). Responsible for exercise sessions and office hours.	
2021	Theories of Accounting Disclosure, Prof. Hui Chen , Graduate (25 students). Responsible for coordinating students' presentations and papers selection.	
2015	Introduction to Econometrics, Prof. Patrick Gagliardini , Undergraduate. Responsible for exercise sessions.	Università della Svizzera Italiana

TEACHING CERTIFICATES

2024	Teaching Skills Program Diploma , Teaching portfolio, course planning, complex teaching settings, peer observation	University of Zurich
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Professional Experience

European Central Bank, Monetary Policy

Frankfurt Am Main, Germany

INTERN AND RESEARCH ANALYST

2019-2020

Research assistant to the paper Eisenschmidt et al. (2024) "Monetary Policy Transmission in Segmented Markets", JFE.

Save the Children, Switzerland

Zurich, Switzerland

EXTERNAL CONSULTANT

2020

Co-author of "Endline Report from Home-Based Preschool Model" with Valeria Kunz and Sidibe Kalifa

UBS Wealth Management Chief Investment Office

Zurich, Switzerland

REAL ESTATE INTERN RESEARCHER

2018

Co-author of the internal publication "Buying a House in Switzerland" with Matthias Holzhey and Maciej Skoczek

Awards, Fellowships, & Grants

2024-2025	Research grant for visiting research stay abroad in academic year 2024-2025 , Doc.Mobility - University of Zurich
2024	Allowance for international conferences , University of Zurich
2014-2015	Scholarship for meritorious students , Fondazione Zonta Club Scholarship for meritorious students , Fondazione SODESKA

Academic Service

2021-2025	Theses supervision , Graduate and undergraduate students, coordinator of the chair	University of Zurich
2025	Reviewer , papers selection for the 14th Accounting Research Workshop, Zurich	
2023-2024	Reading group organizer , organizer of weekly accounting reading group for PhD students	
2022-2024	Co-leader of CareerElixir , Peer mentoring group for women in academia	

Skills

Languages, Italian (Native), English (Fluent), Spanish (Intermediate), German (Lower-intermediate)

Computer Software, Stata, LaTeX, Python, Wolfram Mathematica

References

Hui Chen (supervisor), Professor, University of Zurich, Plattenstrasse 14, 8032 Zurich, hui.chen@business.uzh.ch

Paul Fischer, Professor, The Wharton School, 321 Steinberg Hall-Dietrich Philadelphia (PA) USA, pef@wharton.upenn.edu

Evgeny Petrov, Professor, University of Zurich, Plattenstrasse 14, 8032 Zurich, evgeny.petrov@business.uzh.ch